

AAC for academic access, *in one page.*

Give your students the words to think about the lesson, not just label it.

The whole idea: a device that only requests is a remote control. Academic access lets a student comment, question, compare, and reason about any lesson. You don't need a special vocabulary word for every topic; a handful of flexible **core words** does the thinking across every subject.

1 Fringe names it, core lets him think

"Photosynthesis" and "denominator" are fringe words: he can label the topic, but labeling isn't thinking. The words that let him reason are core words he already has, and they work everywhere:

Compare more, less, same, different

Cause & change make, stop, change, happen

Describe big, fast, hard, good, bad

Question & think what, why, how, not, think

2 Model while you teach

Aided language input means you talk while touching the words on his system. It isn't a separate speech session; it's a way of doing the lesson you're already teaching.

- Touch one or two key words as you say them, not every word.
- Model to show, not to quiz. No "what's this?" or "show me."
- Ask a real question, then wait a silent ten. Give him room to have an idea.

Same six words, three subjects — read-aloud: "he CHANGED, he feels DIFFERENT, what do you THINK?"; math: "we need MORE, SAME or DIFFERENT?"; science: "it STOPPED, something HAPPENED, why?"

3 Start impossibly small: word of the week

Pick **one core word**. Put it on a sticky note. Model it a few times an hour, in every subject, all week. By Friday it's his, and it works everywhere. One student, one word, one week is the whole ask.



Five seconds, every setting. Visible, On, In reach, Charged, Every setting. None of this works if the device is in the backpack during instruction.

It's everyone's to build.

How I'd like us to share this device — you enrich your corner, together we protect the core.

The device belongs to the student, and it works best when everyone feeds it. You know your classroom's language better than anyone, so you should be adding the words your lessons need — not waiting on me. This is how I'd like us to work (there's no district policy; this is the model I'm advocating for).

You, in your classroom

- Add the lesson & topic words your teaching needs
- Build the fringe pages for your units
- Model daily; honor every attempt
- You know your room's language best

Home & other settings

- Add family, food & daily-life words
- Enrich for the places you share the student
- Same device, real words from every corner

Me (SLP / AT)

- Set up the core backbone & the guardrails
- Coach you to add words without breaking things
- Keep backups; catch drift early
- Not the gate — the support

The one rule that makes this work: the core stays put. Add fringe and topic vocabulary freely in your lane, but never move a core button — that's the muscle memory the student navigates by. Back up your changes and loop me in, and I'll help you add without breaking his layout.

How support works

Good AAC training isn't a one-time workshop. It's a cycle we run together: **teach → model → coach → review**. The SLP explains the concept, models it with your student, coaches you in the moment in your room, then reviews what's working and helps you pick the next small step. The most useful thing you can do: **ask the SLP to come model in your room**. That's the request we most want to get, and device lending means you can practice on a system with the same layout.

Core stays put, fringe is open

Here's the line that keeps distributed editing safe. A fluent user finds a word by muscle memory, the way you find a key on a keyboard, so **core words never move** — moving one erases that memory. But **fringe and topic vocabulary is yours to add** in your setting. Enrich freely; just don't rearrange the core, and loop me in so I can keep a backup and catch any drift.

Start Monday: one student, one core word, device out during instruction, ask a real question and wait, and invite the SLP in. That's it. You don't have to do all of it — you have to start.